

U.S. Special Operations Command

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Requirement #/OPR

M209506918657

Market Research, Commerciality, Sole Source Determination

For commercial items IAW FAR Part 12 (SAP & Below) and non-commercial items IAW FAR Part 13 (SAT and below)

V: May 26 Beta

Customer Requirement

Requestor Capt Benjamin Tarango

Project Title Shark Marine Nav Tablet II

Description of Supply/Service

The requirement is for the procurement of the Shark Marine Tablet 2 underwater navigation system. Its intended use is to provide sub-surface navigation, sonar integration, and critical situational awareness for Special Operations Forces (SOF) dive operations. The required brand name is Shark Marine Tablet 2, manufactured by Shark Marine Technologies. Shark Marine Tablet 2 accessory side mount assembly with track slide. Compact floating GPS system for shallow use. Includes a compact floating GPS head with a 10m cable, a cable wrap bracket for use with the shark marine accessory slide mount, includes case.

Est. Contract Price \$88,500.00

Classification UNCLASSIFIED

☐ OCONUS☒ Commercial Item☐ Non Commercial Item**Customer Suggested Sources**☐ Additional Info

Vendor Name/Address	Point of Contact	Socioeconomic Status	CAGE/UEI	Findings
SHARK MARINE TECHNOLOGIES INC	905-687-6672	LB	L3436	

Add Vendor

Remove Vendor

Customer Type of Research Conducted☐ Additional Info

Internet Search

Other Companies known for Surface/SubSurface Navigation: GreenSea IQ, Teledyne Marine, VideoRay, and Riptide Autonomous

Expert Opinion

[REDACTED] The brand name product is essential to the Government's requirements due to its specific software integration, hardware mounting specifications, and unique data interfaces required to synchronize with MARSOC's current propulsion inventory.

Contact with Industry

SHARK MARINE TECHNOLOGIES INC Jim Honey Inside Sales Rep Provide me with the initial quote and various pieces of equipment they had available based on the battalion's requirement.

Prior Purchase

N/A

Other

Customer Justification for Sole Source/Brand Name (if applicable)☐ Additional Info

The Dive Locker currently employs legacy Shark Marine Navigation tablets for introductory training at Stone Bay and various DFT exercises. Familiarity with this equipment will ensure a seamless transition to newer models and reduce uncertainty for operators. Upcoming evaluation exercises leave the unit with strict timeline and budget constraints for training. Procuring alternative navigation systems would require 30 to 45 days just to establish a third-party training contract. The Dive Locker has endured a four-year capability gap in this area, relying solely on limited training stock and contracted support to fulfill mission requirements. Market research, including a review of commercial off-the-shelf (COTS) dive navigation boards, confirms that other companies' similar products lack the required integration features and cannot be retrofitted or modified to meet MARSOC's specialized operational needs. Comparing to other companies such as GreenSea IQ, Teledyne Marine, VideoRay, and Riptide Autonomous. Some of which are world class brands. We found the following issues where they fall short of MARSOC required DPV integration that Shark Marine Nav tablet II meets.

Company: Greensea IQ
Model: EOD Edge / OPENSEA
Issue: Software Focused

Justification: Greensea primarily provides the software and navigation "brain" (OPENSEA). While world-class, they do not produce a purpose-built, all-in-one diver tablet with the same specific physical mounting and integrated sonar ergonomics as the Navigator II.

Company: Teledyne Marine
Model: Diver6 / RDI DVLs

Issue: Component vs. System

Justification: Teledyne is a global leader in Doppler Velocity Logs (DVLs). However, their "Diver6" system is primarily a tracking/telemetry system for surface monitoring, not a standalone, DPV-mounted tactical navigation computer.

Company: VideoRay

Model: Mission Specialist Systems

Issue: Platform Specific

Justification: VideoRay excels in ROV (Remote Operated Vehicle) tablets and controllers. Their systems are not optimized for diver-worn or DPV-mounted use cases and lack the specific MARSOC diver interface software.

Company: Riptide Autonomous

Model: UUV Navigation Tablet

Issue: Unmanned Focus

Justification: Their navigation stacks are designed for Unmanned Underwater Vehicles (UUVs). Adapting their military-grade INS (Inertial Navigation Systems) to a diver-viewable tablet would require significant custom R&D and hardware engineering.

While American companies like Greensea IQ produce superior navigation software, they do not provide a 'Turn-Key' ruggedized hardware solution that is pre-certified for mounting on our SUEX XJ DPV inventory. Selecting an American software-only solution would require the Government to fund a separate hardware development contract to create a custom tablet, leading to unacceptable delays of 6 months and a duplication of cost [REDACTED]

"U.S. components from providers like Teledyne would require custom-fabricated pressure housings and mounting brackets to be utilized by a diver. Shark Marine is the only provider offering a form factor specifically designed for the low-drag profiles required for high-speed DPV transit. Use of non-integrated components would increase hydrodynamic drag, reducing the DPV's mission range by an estimated 10%-15%." That's (1-1.5KM) which would force the dive team to:

1. Abort the mission due to insufficient battery reserves for the return/exfiltration leg.
2. Break concealment and surface early to navigate via GPS, exposing the team to enemy ISR (Intelligence, Surveillance, and Reconnaissance).
3. Discard expensive propulsion assets sub-surface if batteries deplete before reaching the recovery extraction point.

Other/General
Findings (if applicable)

Customer Market Research Signature

The above market research documentation is complete and accurate and represents an appropriate level of review for the complexity of the requirement.

The KO is not required to document Market Research at or below the simplified acquisition threshold (FAR 10.001(b)(2))

Contracting Requirement

NAICS	334511	PSC	4220	☒ Supply	☐ Service	☐ Construction
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Contracting Market Research Requirements (PGI 210.001)

☐ Additional Info

Methods used to conduct market research

CS reached out to Shark Marine Technologies, Inc. to ask whether they had any authorized distributors. They confirmed they did not have any authorized distributors or resellers except for DLA sales through Darley Defense. In reaching out to Darley Defense, they provided a lead time of five months and two weeks before these items would be delivered.

Timeframe in which market research was conducted

Analysis of the capabilities of the offerors that were identified

Conclusion reached as a result of market research

Due to the lead time not meeting the unit's mission requirement, we will be pursuing a sole source contract with Shark Marine Technologies.

Contracting Mandatory Sources

☐ Additional Info

Agency Inventories (FAR 8.103)(a)(1))	☐ Available ☒ Unavailable	Excess From Other Agencies (FAR 8.103)(a)(2))	☐ Available ☒ Unavailable
Ability One (Services) (FAR 8.102)	☐ Available ☒ Unavailable	Specific Supplies and Services (FAR 8.101)	☐ Available ☒ Unavailable
Federal Supply Schedule (FAR 8.104)	☐ Available ☒ Unavailable	Ability One (Supply) (FAR 8.103)(a)(4)	☐ Available ☒ Unavailable
Federal Prison Industries (FAR 8.103)(a)(3)) ☐ Available ☒ Unavailable ☐ FPI Waiver Attached ☐ Not Comparable to Commercial Industry			

Contracting Anticipated Solicitation Method

☐ Additional Info

☐ Competitive
 ☒ Limited Competition
 ☐ Small Business SetAside
 ☐ Other

Contracting Market Research Approval

☐ Additional Info

The above market research documentation is complete and accurate and represents an appropriate level of review for the complexity of the requirement.

Contracting Sole Source Approval (only for actions at or below SAT)

The above sole source justification is complete and accurate and represents an appropriate level of review.

Date	Typed Name, Rank, Title	Signature (for Sole Source Approval)